

## HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

### Document-Based Question

**US.41** — Analyze the causes of the Great Depression, including: • Bank failures • Laissez-faire politics • Buying on margin • Overextension of credit • Crash of the stock market • Overproduction in agriculture • Excess consumerism in manufacturing • High tariffs • Rising unemployment

**US.42** — Explain the causes of the Dust Bowl, and its social, geographic, and economic impacts.

**US.43** — Describe the impact of the Great Depression on the American people, including mass unemployment, migration, and Hoovervilles.

**TEACHER EDITION — scoring guide and expected evidence. Not for student distribution.**

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

**Directions.** Analyze the three primary sources below. Then respond to the prompt using evidence from ALL THREE documents and your own historical knowledge.

### The sources

#### Document A

Herbert Hoover, Press Statement on the Economy, October 25, 1929 (National Archives, public domain)

“The fundamental business of the country — that is, production and distribution of commodities — is on a sound and prosperous basis...I have no fear of the fundamental strength of our business and economic structure.”

## SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT A

**H** — Historical context

What was happening when  
this was made?

**I** — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or  
hear it?

**P** — Purpose

What was it trying to make  
the audience do or think?

**P** — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how  
does that shape it?

## Document B

Franklin D. Roosevelt, First Inaugural Address, March 4, 1933 (National Archives, public domain)

“The money changers have fled from their high seats in the temple of our civilization. We may now restore that temple to the ancient truths. The measure of the restoration lies in the extent to which we apply social values more noble than mere monetary profit...Happiness lies not in the mere possession of money; it lies in the joy of achievement, in the thrill of creative effort. The joy and moral stimulation of work no longer must be forgotten in the mad chase of evanescent profits.”

## SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT B

### **H** — Historical context

What was happening when this was made?

### **I** — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or hear it?

### **P** — Purpose

What was it trying to make the audience do or think?

### **P** — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how does that shape it?

## Document C

Senate Finance Committee testimony of Marriner Eccles (Federal Reserve Chairman nominee), February 5, 1935 (Congressional Record, public domain)

“Mass production has to be accompanied by mass consumption...As long as we continue to render the masses of people increasingly impotent economically, we shall not be able to bring about recovery. We must find ways of increasing their purchasing power.”

## SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT C

### **H** — Historical context

What was happening when  
this was made?

### **I** — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or  
hear it?

### **P** — Purpose

What was it trying to make  
the audience do or think?

### **P** — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how  
does that shape it?

The question

PROMPT: Using all three documents and your knowledge of the Great Depression (1929–1941), construct an argument that answers the following question: How did competing diagnoses of the Great Depression's causes reflect fundamentally different visions of the government's proper role in the economy? In your response, you MUST: 1. Analyze each document using the HIPP framework (Historical context, Intended audience, Purpose, Point of view)

1. at least one HIPP element per document. 2. Identify the different diagnoses of the Depression offered by each document and connect them to the speaker's broader ideological position. 3. Construct a central argument that uses evidence from all three documents AND at least two pieces of outside historical knowledge to explain how these competing diagnoses shaped the policy debate of the 1930s. 4. Evaluate which diagnosis

2. Hoover's, FDR's, or Eccles's

3. most accurately accounted for the structural causes of the Depression and explain why

Plan your answer

|            |  |
|------------|--|
| Your claim |  |
|------------|--|

| Source            | Evidence you will use | Why it supports your claim |
|-------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| Document A        |                       |                            |
| Document B        |                       |                            |
| Document C        |                       |                            |
| Outside knowledge |                       |                            |

### Write your response

## Scoring guide

| Pts      | 6-point scale                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>6</b> | <b>Exemplary.</b> All three documents analyzed with at least one precise HIPP element each (historical context accurately identified for all three). Central argument is clear, defensible, and directly answers the question about competing diagnoses and government role. Uses evidence from all three documents AND at least two pieces of accurate outside historical knowledge. Evaluates which diagnosis is most accurate with specific reasoning. Writing is coherent, well-organized, and historically rigorous. |
| <b>5</b> | <b>Advanced.</b> Three documents analyzed with HIPP elements (may miss one element). Central argument is clear and uses all three documents plus at least two outside facts. Evaluation of which diagnosis is most accurate is present but reasoning is partially developed.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>4</b> | <b>Proficient.</b> Two documents analyzed with HIPP (third may be missing or superficial). Argument uses evidence from at least two documents and one outside fact. Connects diagnoses to government role with adequate reasoning. Evaluation present but may lack depth.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>3</b> | <b>Adequate.</b> At least two documents referenced. Argument addresses the question but evidence use is uneven — may rely heavily on one document. HIPP analysis is present for at least one document. Some outside knowledge present.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>2</b> | <b>Developing.</b> Only one or two documents referenced with minimal analysis. Central argument is unclear or only partially addresses the prompt. Limited use of outside knowledge. Little or no HIPP analysis.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>1</b> | <b>Beginning.</b> Response summarizes one document without analysis. No argument constructed. No HIPP analysis. No outside knowledge.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>0</b> | No response or completely off-topic.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

**Expected evidence and document analysis.** DOCUMENT ANALYSIS EXPECTATIONS: - Document A (Hoover): Context = post-Black Thursday; Audience = public/markets; Purpose = reassurance; POV = market self-correction, limited government - Document B (FDR): Context = Depression nadir 1933; Audience = national public; Purpose = reframe Depression as moral failure of speculation; POV = moral-structural critique of laissez-faire capitalism - Document C (Eccles): Context = 1935 Banking Act debate; Audience = Senate; Purpose = advocate demand-side intervention; POV = proto-Keynesian / underconsumption theory KEY EVIDENCE EXPECTED: Stock market speculation and margin buying; Black Tuesday (October 29, 1929); bank failures (9,000+, 1930–1933); Smoot-Hawley Tariff (1930); Federal Reserve monetary contraction; 25% unemployment (1933); Hoover's voluntarism and RFC; First New Deal programs (NIRA, AAA, CCC); Second New Deal (Social Security, Wagner Act) as demand-side response.

**Sourcing.** Every document above carries its own citation as written in the item record. Verify each against the holding institution before classroom use — an unsourced primary source is worse than a missing one.

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History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.